E Sum 1 Grammar notes

The pluperfect tense: *"what had happened"*

- This tense is used to describe:
  - **What you had been doing**: (*I'd been eating*)
  - **What you had done** (*I had eaten*)
- The pluperfect tense is a **COMPOUND** tense, just like the perfect tense. This just means that it is "composed" or has two parts: the **AUXILIARY** verb (**avoir** or **être**) plus the **past participle**.
- To form the pluperfect tense is easy, provided you can do the perfect tense…
  - Choose the **correct auxiliary** as you would for the perfect tense
  - Put this into the **IMPERFECT** tense
  - Add the **past participle** as usual.

> - *le film avait fini* *j'étais arrivé en retard*
> *nous étions partis à 8H* *elle avait commandé un coca*
> *il avait neigé* *il avait plu*

- All other rules such as **PDO**, are exactly the same as in the perfect tense:

> - *Les films que j'avais vuS en vacances.*
> *J'étais content de penser à toutes les jolies filles que j'avais rencontrées*

The conditional perfect tense:

"what would have happened"

- This tense is used to describe:
  - **What you would have been doing**: *(I'd have been eating)*
  - **What you would have done** *(I'd have eaten)*
- This is another **COMPOUND** tense. The auxiliary goes into the **CONDITIONAL** tense, and then the past participle is added:

> - *je me serais fâché* *elle aurait refusé de le faire*
> *nous nous serions couchés à 10 H* *ils auraient acheté du vin*
> *j'aurais invité ma soeur* *tu aurais pu venir*

"Could(n't) have…" "Should(n't) have…"

- With the conditional perfect of DEVOIR and POUVOIR plus the infinitive, you can express regrets/reproaches in the past of the type above.

> - *Tu aurais pu VENIR!* *il aurait pu AIDER!*
> *j'aurais pu y ALLER!* *nous aurions pu le PAYER!*
> *elle aurait pu lui FAIRE mal!* *tu aurais pu nous le DIRE avant!*

> - *Elle aurait dû S'EXCUSER!* *j'aurais dû le DEMANDER!*

nous aurions dû DIRE non! *ils n'auraient pas dû CONDUIRE!*
elle n'aurait jamais dû y ALLER *tu aurais dû l'AIDER!*

A third and final "if…" clause

- This allows you to **speculate** as to **what would have happened** if something had been different:
  - **si + pluperfect + conditional perfect** (or cond. perfect + si + pluperfect)
  - *Si j'avais reçu une invitation je serais allé à la fête*
    J'aurais acheté le CD si j'avais eu assez d'argent
- A reminder of si clauses 1 and 2
  - **si + present + future**
  - **si + imperfect + conditional**
  - *s'il ne pleut pas, je ferai du jardinage cet après-midi*
    s'il ne pleuvait pas, je ferais du jardinage
- "**Si clause number three" is different** because it is the only one of the three where there is no chance of it "coming true". It is too late, and all in the past. Si clauses one and two, however, have a chance, however slim, of coming true.

S'il fait un petit effort, il sera fort en français	**POSSIBLE**
S'il faisait un petit effort, il serait fort en français	**UNLIKELY**
S'il avait fait un petit effort, il aurait été fort en français.	**IMPOSSIBLE**